

## AFFORDABLE NYLON

With the invention of nylon in 1938 by the American chemist Wallace Carothers, stockings, which were previously made of expensive silk, suddenly became much cheaper. After World War II, the American company Glen Raving Knitting Mills created a new two-legged garment by joining nylon stockings together—now called tights or panty hose.



*Nylon can stretch a long way without tearing.*

**Women test nylon stockings, 1939**

## NON-SWEAT CLOTHING

Used for making outdoor clothing, Gore-Tex® was discovered in 1969 by the American engineer Robert W. Gore. He found that rapidly expanding a substance called polytetrafluoroethylene, commonly known as Teflon™ (see p.195), produced a new material that is both waterproof and breathable, allowing sweat to escape.



### ▲ ALL-WEATHER GEAR

*Gore-Tex® is now used to make a wide range of breathable, waterproof clothing, including skiing gear and other sportswear.*